

What is NVivo

NVIVO is designed to assist you in creating a research project and using common qualitative techniques for organising, analysing and sharing data. NVivo can help you manage, explore and discover patterns in your data but it cannot replace your analytical expertise.

A full list of compatibility differences can be found on the [Nvivo Help Pages](#).

At this time Library computer have access to Nvivo Version 14 only.

Version 14 is the currently supported version at UQ.

Nvivo comes in versions for both Windows and Mac.

Unfortunately they are not the same and the Mac version has some notably missing features including the ability to produce reports and both compound and group queries.

Nvivo projects from different operation systems are not compatible with each other. It is strongly recommended that anyone using Nvivo for group work ensures that each group member is using the same operating system and Nvivo version number.

Your first project

Exercise

Creating a project

- Create a new blank project
- New project dialogue box that has 2 steps (Mac only has 1 step – Has autosave tick box on the screen). Put in a project title which will form part of the file name
- Name the file and store locally on the computers hard drive.

Do NOT save to a cloud file location e.g. OneDrive as this can lead to file corruption and loss of data. Note that windows 11 document and desktop locations are by default cloud based locations

- The Text content language option is the language that the majority of your data will be in. Nvivo works well with languages that read left to right but can experience issues with languages that read right to left such as Arabic, Hebrew, Persian, Sindhi and Urdu.

Setting the text language is important as each language has an associated dictionary that helps with Text Search and Word Frequency queries. They also have their own sets

of 'Stop' words (not including Chinese and Japanese) that are filtered out when running Text Search and Word Frequency queries.

- Choose Next for Step 2.
- Autosave – No by default to allow for undoing mistakes
- Recovery files in case of project issues. May not be created or saved correctly if the original project is stored and run from a cloud location

If an Nvivo tour window pops up choose to Skip Tour in top right corner

Screen overview

There are 3 parts to the Nvivo screen

- Navigator – Blue bar on left side of screen
- List View – immediately to the right of the navigator
- Details View – displays only once an item has been opened from the List view. Tabs will open across the top of the details view. One for each opened item.
Note: Right mouse clicking opened tabs will give you the option to close the tab, close all but the tab you clicked on or close all tabs

Adding files to NVivo

All imported files are stored underneath the Data title in the Files area of the Navigator.

Folders can be created to keep files organised.

Exercise

Creating folders and Importing files

- In the Navigator - Right click Files – New Folder
- Name the folder Interviews and Click OK (Mac - Done)

Use Import Ribbon to bring in various types of files; can also right click in the list area and choose from various import options. Common file types can be dragged and dropped directly into Nvivo as well e.g. docs, pdfs, audio and images. Special import file types such as excel, bibliographic and NCapture cannot be dragged and dropped.

- Close the Files description screen in list view – Click close at the bottom of the screen to do so
- Import Ribbon – Files – (Mac – Choose Documents) - Navigate to where the files were extracted to
- Select all the files - Barbara, Barrier islands and Cape Lookout, Helen transcript, Sea grant Fact Sheet and William

- Mac – need to import each file type individually
- Click Open (Mac Done)
- Windows - Click Import

Mac – Accept the defaults and Choose Done if it asks about Document Properties

Preparing survey data for NVivo

- Export data from the survey software of your choice in an excel format – preferably excel 2007 and later (.xlsx) format
- Open the file in Excel
- Closed questions are answers supplied by drop down lists
- Open questions are free text answers
- Each respondent requires a unique identifier – you can generate this via survey software or by adding your own. Adding your own is usually neater
- Each respondent must be on a single row
- Ensure your data is as tidy as possible (e.g. locations are spelled the same way – all Brisbane not bris, bne, Brisbane) as once imported the dataset cannot be edited

Importing a survey

As will all file/data imports ensure the excel file is closed

- Import ribbon – Survey – Choose survey type as necessary
- Select the excel file and choose open
- Respondents stored as cases – using the unique identifiers
- Closed ended questions stored as case attributes
- Open ended questions stored as codes
- Next
- Check the data format and date format
- Next
- Manage the respondents
- Choose the location name and change location if necessary
- Ensure the unique identifier is chosen for the unique id for cases
- Check the classification if necessary
- Next
- Identify the open and closed questions – Nvivo does not always get this correct

Vital to get this correct at this stage

The only way to correct mistakes is to reimport the data

Questions can also be corrected and tidied at this stage if necessary

- Click Finish

Click close when the import is finished

Survey data management

Closed questions columns are grey

Open question columns are white and are codable

Closed questions are stored as attributes which can be charted

- Explore – Charts – Chart dataset coding by attribute value

Open ended questions are codable

- Codes – Highlight text in survey – drag and drop to a code as necessary

Codes has a folder matching the open ended questions

Open the coded questions and you could recode to other areas as necessary

Open a File

To open these files double click them – Double click Barbara

Note: Barbara opens in the detail view with a tab at the top

Edit a text file

Mac – Click Edit tick box on top right

Windows – Click Edit tick box in top left

Mac – Edit tab – Styles on right hand side

Windows – Document tab - Styles

Hint: Windows only - Right click an open file tab to Close All open file or Class All but This (to close all open files except for the one that was right clicked)

Coding theory

Coding correctly is essential as it will help you to organise unstructured data such as interview transcripts, pdf files, audio files or pictures into Codes. These codes will be the main themes contained within the unstructured data and can include items such as strategies, concepts, behaviours, attitudes or recurring ideas to name but a few.

Coding requires you to work through your data and identify the pieces of information you wish to code. This could include entire blocks of text or just a few words as an example.

Coding is the most important part of your project. It will take a lot of time but it is vital you get it right.

The way you code will be defined by you and your analytical choices.

See <https://guides.library.uq.edu.au/how-to-find/research-data/work-with-data> for more information

Starting to code in NVivo

In Nvivo you organise your main themes/ideas by 'coding' into Codes. Codes are like folders that will hold all the themes/ideas that match the folders name or Code. Coding can be completed in several ways that includes drag and drop, using options available via the right mouse click and making choices via the ribbons and buttons at the top of the screen.

When creating codes a Description field is available. Descriptions are optional but necessary if you are going to create a code book for sharing with others (more on this later). Descriptions can also be useful for reminding you about your thinking process if you take a break from your research and come back to it later. Descriptions can be updated at any time.

Exercise

- Open the file – Barbara
- Select and click Codes in the navigator pane
- Close the codes description in list view if necessary

Create Top-level and Children codes first

You can create your codes first if you wish. Child codes are a great way to break coding into more specific areas. For example a code called Economy could have child codes called Fishing and Real Estate Development and the Fishing code could have its own children – one called Recreational and another called Commercial. In this example Economy is the parent to both Fishing and Real Estate while Fishing is a parent to Recreational and Commercial.

- Click Codes in the navigator view
 - 1) Right click on the blank area inside list view
 - 2) Choose New Code (Mac – New Top-Level Code...)
 - 3) Enter the name – Connection to down east
 - 4) Click OK (Mac – Done) or Press Enter/Return
- Repeat steps 1 thru 4 above but use the following names...
 - Environment
 - Years in Town
 - Water Quality
- Single click the code – Environment
 - a) Right click the Environment code and choose New Code... from the pop up menu
 - b) Enter the name – Habitat
 - c) Click OK (Mac – Done) or Press Enter/Return
- Repeat steps a, b and c above but use the name – Landscape

Notice that two children codes – Landscape and Habitat - have been created beneath Environment

Coding - Drag and Drop method

- Ensure Codes is selected in Navigator view
- Select whole paragraph of Barbaras answer to Henry's first question "Tell me about your personal and family history..."
- Drag and drop the paragraph on Connection to down east in Codes list view
- Highlight Barbaras second answer
- Drag and drop into – Connection to down east

Create a new code - Right click – Code Selection method

What if you find new information that needs a new code...

- Locate Henry question – "So what attracted you to return to this area"

- Highlight all Barbaras response
- Right Click – Code Selection – (Mac – To New Code)
- Mac - Enter the name – Community
- Mac - Press the Enter/Return key on your keyboard

Windows see below for further details

- The ‘Select Code Items’ dialog box opens
- On Right hand side in the Create New column single click - Top Level Code
- A ‘New Code’ appears on the left hand side of the dialog box underneath Codes
- Enter the name – Community – Press Enter/Return on your keyboard
- Click Code Selection to ‘Community’ blue button at bottom of dialog box
- New code Community appears in List view with text coded to it

Investigating codes in more detail

Double click a code in the list pane to open it in the details view. This will show all the pieces of coded information in that code.

- Double click Connect to down east code to see the two Barbara codes

Developing your coding

Coding is not set in stone. You can rename Codes, change the coding on previously coded items and multi-code previously coded items by coding them to other codes.

In Barbara Locate the first Henry question

- Navigator Panel - Select Codes
 - Close the Codes description screen if necessary
 - Select - “My family moved here when I was two years old in 1969” and drag to the Years in Town code in the list view
 - Select “My parents still live here”
 - Right mouse click the selection – Code to Recent Codes (Mac – Recent Codes or Cases bottom of pop up) – Click Years in Town (Codes)
 - Double click Years in Town code to open it – point out the two pieces of coded text
 - Switch back to Barbara file
 - Locate the second question ‘And you’ve lived Down East how long?’
 - Select – “My husband and I bought this little cottage in ‘96”
 - Code to Years in Town – Students choice in coding methods
- Switch back to Years in Town tab to show it has updated with new code

Uncoding

If a mistake in coding is made you can uncode whole passages or selections of a passage.

Exercise

Locate the Henry question – ‘So what attracted you to return to this area’ – Question 1 5th question down

- Select from the second sentence “And I wanted him to see this particular....” to the end of the paragraph.
- **Windows** - Right Click – Uncode – Select Community by placing a tick next to it in the Select Project Items dialog box – Click OK
- **Mac** - Right Click – Uncode Selection – From Existing Codes or Cases... - Choose from the available options in the dialog box (Community) and click Select or Choose from the list of Recent Codes at the bottom of the pop up menu (Community)

Renaming a code

Windows

- Single Click Environment code
- Single click Environment code a second time
- Environment code should now be in renaming mode – Change name to Natural Environment
- Press Enter/Return

Mac

- Right mouse click Environment – Get Info – Change name to Natural Environment – click Done

Moving a code

- Single Click the code – Water Quality – to select it
- Click and Drag the Water Quality code over the top of Natural Environment and release the mouse
- Water Quality should now be a child code of Natural Environment

Note: To promote a child code to a parent code in windows you must click and drag the child to the Code heading in the navigator pane.

In Mac you can right click a code and choose Move to Top Level or you can click and drag.

- Single click – Water Quality – Drag Water Quality to Codes in the Navigator – Release the mouse
- Water Quality is now a Parent Code again
- Repeat the steps for making Water Quality a child of Natural Environment

Merging Codes

Merging codes can be necessary if you believe you have multiple codes that are so similar to each other they should just be one item.

- Single click Community Code
- Right click Community code – Cut (Mac – Copy)
- Right click the code to be merged into – Connection to down east - Merge into selected code
- Choose all the necessary option in the Merge into Code dialog box
- Click OK (Mac – click Merge)

Windows – Community will be gone and Connection to down east will be updated with merged data.

Mac – Community will still exist and Connection to down east will be updated with merged data. Mac will need to Delete the Community code – Single click Community code – Press Delete key on keyboard – Confirm Delete by clicking Delete in Delete Item dialog box

Coding Stripes

Coding Stripes allow you to keep track of items you have coded and where you have coded them to.

To view coding stripes...

- Go to Barbara tab
- **Windows** - Document Tab – Coding Stripes or use Coding Stripes button at top of Barbara details view
- Choose All
- **Mac** – Details pane – Coding Stripes at top – same row as Edit tick box
- Choose All
- Coding stripes pane opens on right hand side of screen
- Clicking an individual stripe will highlight the text in the tab

Note: Once clicked you must choose the highlight button and None to unhighlight

Note: To Change the colour of the coding stripe in the Code Stripes Pane you must choose the Code in list view – Right mouse click and choose the colour at the bottom

Highlight

- Document Tab – Highlight or use Highlight button at top of Barbara details
- Choose All Coding (Mac – Coding for All Codes or Cases)
- Coded text will be highlighted
- Choose Highlight button again and None to unhighlight text

Coding other file types

Images

- Load image
- Highlight image – select the lighthouse
- Right click inside the selection – Code (Mac – Code Selection – To existing Codes or Cases or via recent codes or cases at bottom of pop up menu)
- Choose the location to Code to – Expand Natural Environment code - Landscape
- Click below the image to clear any selection marks (Mac may need to use the magnifier to zoom out to do this)

To use the Image log

- Click in the edit box
- Make Selection first
- Edit tab – Insert Row (Mac click little plus sign) – Selected region coordinates will appear in the log
- Enter the log text

Mac must exit edit mode to be able to select and code text

- Select the text
- Right Click – Select required code
- Click code selection button at the bottom

PDFs

- Load document
- Select Text (text only) (Mac – T) or Region (include images) (Mac – Dotted square)
- Use Region if you wish to include images as part of the selection
- Make selection as necessary
- Right click – code selection

Code Panel

A way of seeing codes while using the navigator to show other parts of the project in list view

- Click Code Panel at the top of the details screen (Mac – top right near Edit box)
- Code Panel appears on the right hand side of the screen
- Shows Codes and Cases
- Useable in text files only (not available in images or pdfs etc)

Cases

Cases are containers that keep all things about a participant in one place e.g a Case for Barbara will allow us to see all the pieces of the Barbara file that have been coded to different Codes

Exercise:

- Go to Cases – Close Case description page if necessary by clicking Close at bottom of list view – Right mouse click – New case (Mac – New Top-Level Case...) – Enter the name Barbara – Press Enter (Mac – click Done)
- Go to Barbara file
- Find the Henry question “So what attracted you to return to this area” – 5th question down
- Select: “I’ve always thought it was some of the most beautiful beaches and just water anywhere” and Code to both Landscape and Water Quality codes and to Barbara case
Mac – Select text as above
Right mouse click – Code Selection – To Existing Codes or Cases... - Ensure Codes is selected on left – expand Natural Environment (on right) – tick Landscape and Water Quality – (a minus sign will appear next to Codes on the left) – Click Cases – tick Barbara – Click Select
- Open Barbara Case and show how Years in Town codes are not visible
- Switch back to Years in Town Code
- Select each entry in Years in Town and Code to Barbara case
- Switch to Barbara case to demonstrate updated codes
- Open Coding Stripes to show where each piece of data is coded

Case Classifications

Case Classifications allow you to add attributes to cases such as demographic data for interviewees or survey respondents. Depending on the data you are studying case classifications could relate to businesses, institutions, people or countries for example.

Note: Classifications can be added directly into Nvivo.

Classification sheets can also be created using spreadsheets. Note that when creating a classification sheet via a spreadsheet the names/unique identifier must be exactly the same as the case names/unique identifier in Nvivo. Even an extra space at the end of the name will result in new case entries

Mac - Hierarchical names

Mac must use full hierarchical names when creating classification sheets. This includes folders and parent codes or cases appended to the name of the file, code or case.

Folder names are followed by two backslashes (\\) and code or case names by single backslashes (\).

e.g. Files\\Interviews\Barbara or Cases\\Barbara

Exercise

- Open a spreadsheet program e.g. Microsoft Excel.
- Save the spreadsheet (File – Save As) with the name - classification sheet
Mac – Must save the file with a .csv file extension
- Populate the classification sheet for Barbara and William as follows. Note that the letter in brackets is the column letter in the spreadsheet so that in Row 1 Column A you will type Person.

Row 1 –	(A) Person	(B) Gender	(C) Age	(D) Township
Row 2 -	(A) Barbara	(B) Female	(C) 40-49	(D) Bettie
Row 3 -	(A) William	(B) Male	(C) 50-59	(D) Straits

Mac – remember to use hierarchical names – Cases\\Barbara

Note that the first column name will become the name for the classification. In this case: Person

- Save the changes to classification sheet file
- Close the file
- Import tab – Classifications – Import Classification Sheets...
- Click Browse and Select the file to import by locating the recently saved classification sheet

- Click Next
- Change the Classification type to Case Classification and ensure the 3 tick boxes are all ticked
- Click Next
- **Windows** - Select the radio button As names and ensure Cases appears in the Location for these cases in this project box
- Ensure Create new cases if they do not exist is ticked
- Choose Next
- If necessary make changes for Step 4 but this is not required in this exercise
- Click Finish

Applying Classifications

In the navigator panel click Cases

- Right click Barbara
- 3rd bottom option – Classification
- If Person is not ticked – Choose Person to apply the classification data

Classifications are used in the next class when looking at queries.

Extra information

Autocoding for Themes

Not available in Mac

Gain an overview of the contents of your documents by Autocoding for Themes. Autocoding for Themes will give you a high level overview of your documents.

Exercise

- Select all files
- Home Tab – Autocode
- Identify Themes (version 12 pro and up)
- If necessary wait for Nvivo to download the file packs. When finished you will see a preview of the identified themes
- Choose next
- Step 3 - Choose Code Sentences for finely coded themes
- Next (or choose Finish)
- Step 4 – Accept the defaults and click Finish

Notice that the image file (Barrier islands and Cape Lookout) has NOT been coded. Only the 4 text based files have been coded

- Navigator panel – Expand Codes (Little arrow on the left) – Autocoded Themes

Autocoding Themes will give a rough idea of the contents of files. Note how not every file is present in every theme. It is important to remember that the Files count is the number of files being coded into a code. References are the number of items from those files. A reference can be an entire paragraph, a sentence or even a single word.

Autocode to cases by speaker name

Previously we have coded manually to cases. Now we are going to code using the names of the speakers. This will work best when set up like the files in this training class ie Speaker name on one line and spoken text on another. Speaker names can be styled using the built in Microsoft Word styles for easier coding

Exercise

- Open William file

- Home tab – Autocode or Right Click the William document and choose Autocode
- Choose Speaker Name – Next
- Enter the name Henry and press Enter (note the green tick to the right of Henry's name indicating his name was found)
- Enter the name William and press Enter (again note the green tick)
- Click Next
- Enter the name Person for the Case Classification (we are looking at Case Classifications next)
- Choose finish
- Go to Cases – See cases for William and Henry
- Delete Henry case

Note: you need to use all the names or speaker information will be coded together with the interviewee name

Note 2: you can autocode by styles if you have styled each name with a heading style from Microsoft Word. This can also be done whilst in Nvivo